

CENTRAL BOARD OF SECONDARY EDUCATION — PRACTICE EXAMINATION**CLASS IX • SOCIAL SCIENCE (SUBJECT CODE: 087) • ACADEMIC SESSION 2026-27****SET F — RAPID FIRE SPEED TEST (30 MINS)****CHAPTER 01: UNDERSTANDING SOCIAL SCIENCE**

TIME ALLOWED: 30 MINUTES

MAXIMUM MARKS: 25 MARKS

SERIES: CBS-IX-SST-SET-F-01

Student's Name: _____

Roll No.: _____

Class & Section: Class IX - _____

Date of Exam: _____

Invigilator's Sign: _____

General Instructions (SET F - Rapid Fire Speed Test):

1. The question paper comprises **25 Rapid Fire Multiple Choice Questions** of **1 mark each**.
2. Designed for **Rapid Recall & High-Speed Accuracy**: Recommended target time is **30 Minutes**.
3. All questions are compulsory. There is no negative marking.
4. Darken the corresponding bubble on the **OMR Sheet** completely using a blue/black ballpoint pen.

⚡ SPEED CHALLENGE INSTRUCTIONS: Answer promptly without looking at notes. Test your instant recall of historical milestones, geographic terms, constitutional provisions, and core economic laws!

Q.1 What is the scientific study and decipherment of ancient inscriptions called?

- (A) Numismatics (B) Epigraphy
(C) Archaeology (D) Palaeontology

Q.2 The scientific study of coins, medals, and monetary tokens is known as:

- (A) Toponymy (B) Stratigraphy
(C) Numismatics (D) Epigraphy

Q.3 Which British scholar successfully deciphered the ancient Ashokan Brahmi script in 1837?

- (A) Sir Mortimer Wheeler (B) James Prinsep
(C) Sir John Marshall (D) Alexander Cunningham

Q.4 Which of the following is an example of a PRIMARY historical source?

- (A) A 2024 textbook written by a modern historian (B) An original copper-plate land grant inscription from 600 CE
(C) A historical fiction movie produced in Hollywood (D) An encyclopedia article summarizing ancient wars

Q.5 According to the geological Law of Superposition, in an undisturbed archaeological excavation:

- (A) The topmost layer is always the oldest (B) The deepest sedimentary layer is the oldest
(C) All layers are exactly the same age (D) Age is determined strictly by soil color

Q.6 Radiocarbon dating (Carbon-14) is scientifically applicable exclusively to:

- (A) Gold coins and silver jewelry (B) Organic materials such as wood, bone, and charcoal
(C) Basalt rock cliffs (D) Iron swords and bronze arrowheads

Q.7 The archaeological method of determining age by counting annual growth rings in preserved wooden timbers is called:

- | | |
|----------------------|-----------------|
| (A) Dendrochronology | (B) Palynology |
| (C) Epigraphy | (D) Numismatics |

Q.8 The scientific analysis of fossil pollen grains to reconstruct ancient climate and vegetation is termed:

- | | |
|------------------|------------------|
| (A) Toponymy | (B) Palynology |
| (C) Stratigraphy | (D) Palaeography |

Q.9 The Kharosthi script utilized in northwestern Ashokan edicts was written in which direction?

- | | |
|------------------------|-------------------|
| (A) Left to right | (B) Right to left |
| (C) Top to bottom only | (D) Bottom to top |

Q.10 Who pioneered the box-grid excavation method in Indian archaeology, preserving vertical stratigraphic balks?

- | | |
|-----------------------|--------------------------|
| (A) Sir William Jones | (B) Sir Mortimer Wheeler |
| (C) James Prinsep | (D) Dayaram Sahni |

Q.11 Which philosopher formulated the principle that a scientific theory must be empirically 'falsifiable'?

- | | |
|-----------------|---------------|
| (A) Karl Popper | (B) Aristotle |
| (C) Adam Smith | (D) Max Weber |

Q.12 The practice of evaluating other cultures strictly according to the biases of one's own culture is known as:

- | | |
|-------------------------|--------------------------|
| (A) Cultural relativism | (B) Ethnocentrism |
| (C) Pluralism | (D) Methodological rigor |

Q.13 In social science research, combining multiple independent data collection methods to cross-verify findings is termed:

- | | |
|--------------------|-------------------|
| (A) Falsification | (B) Triangulation |
| (C) Stratification | (D) Debasement |

Q.14 Which historical traveler from ancient Greece served as an ambassador in Chandragupta Maurya's court and wrote 'Indica'?

- | | |
|--------------|-----------------|
| (A) Fa-Hien | (B) Megasthenes |
| (C) Xuanzang | (D) Al-Biruni |

Q.15 Which Chinese Buddhist pilgrim visited India during the 7th century CE in the reign of King Harshavardhana?

- | | |
|-----------------|----------------------------|
| (A) Megasthenes | (B) Xuanzang (Hiuen Tsang) |
| (C) Ibn Battuta | (D) Marco Polo |

Q.16 The study of place names and geographic settlement titles to trace historical migrations is called:

- | | |
|-----------------|------------------|
| (A) Numismatics | (B) Toponymy |
| (C) Epigraphy | (D) Stratigraphy |

Q.17 What is the half-life of radioactive Carbon-14 (^{14}C)?

- | | |
|---------------------|-----------------|
| (A) 50 years | (B) 5,730 years |
| (C) 1,000,000 years | (D) 24 hours |

Q.18 A modern textbook evaluating ancient Harappan urban planning is classified as a:

- | | |
|-----------------------|----------------------|
| (A) Primary source | (B) Secondary source |
| (C) Tertiary artifact | (D) Fossil record |

Q.19 Statistical quantitative data in social sciences is typically collected through:

- | | |
|-----------------|--|
| (A) Folk songs | (B) Structured sample surveys and questionnaires |
| (C) Oral gossip | (D) Mythological epics |

Q.20 Palaeography is the historical study of:

- | | |
|---------------------------------|---|
| (A) Ancient stone tool knapping | (B) Ancient handwriting, script styles, and decipherment of alphabets |
| (C) Fossil dinosaur bones | (D) Underground cave stalactites |

Q.21 Which discipline studies the spatial distribution of physical features, climatic patterns, and human settlements?

- | | |
|-----------------|-------------------|
| (A) Epigraphy | (B) Geography |
| (C) Numismatics | (D) Anthropometry |

Q.22 A researcher assumes that because two variables rise together, one must cause the other. What logical error is this?

- | | |
|-----------------------------|--|
| (A) Deductive proof | (B) Confusing correlation with causation |
| (C) Empirical triangulation | (D) Stratigraphic superposition |

Q.23 What is the primary civic objective of teaching social sciences in Indian schools according to NCF?

- | | |
|--|---|
| (A) Rote memorization of dates | (B) Fostering critical thinking, constitutional literacy, and democratic values |
| (C) Teaching blind obedience to rulers | (D) Training students for military warfare only |

Q.24 Which ancient Indian historical text by Kalhana chronicles the royal dynasties of Kashmir?

- | | |
|------------------|-------------------|
| (A) Arthashastra | (B) Rajatarangini |
| (C) Indica | (D) Harshacharita |

Q.25 When a researcher consciously avoids letting personal religious, political, or cultural feelings distort factual data, they practice:

- | | |
|-------------------|-----------------|
| (A) Subjectivity | (B) Objectivity |
| (C) Ethnocentrism | (D) Dogmatism |

CBSE CANDIDATE OMR ANSWER RESPONSE GRID (SET F)

01	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	02	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	03	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	04	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	05	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
06	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	07	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	08	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	09	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	10	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
11	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	12	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	13	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	14	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	15	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
16	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	17	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	18	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	19	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	20	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
21	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	22	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	23	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	24	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	25	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D

Total Questions Attempted: ____ / 25

Marks Obtained: ____ / 25

Evaluator's Signature: _____

OFFICIAL ANSWER KEY & RAPID RECALL EXPLANATIONS (SET F)

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Concept & Rapid Recall Analysis
Q.1	(B)	Epigraphy is the scientific study and interpretation of ancient inscriptions carved on stone, metal, or terracotta.
Q.2	(C)	Numismatics is the study of coinage, currency, and medals, providing crucial economic and political historical data.
Q.3	(B)	James Prinsep deciphered the Brahmi script in 1837 using bilingual Indo-Greek coins.
Q.4	(B)	Primary sources are original contemporary artifacts or records created during the exact historical era under study.
Q.5	(B)	The Law of Superposition states that lower sedimentary strata were deposited earlier in time than upper overlying strata.
Q.6	(B)	C-14 dating measures the radioactive decay of carbon isotopes present only in once-living organic matter.
Q.7	(A)	Dendrochronology uses annual tree growth rings to establish absolute calendar dates for ancient wooden beams.
Q.8	(B)	Palynology studies durable microscopic pollen grains preserved in lake beds and archaeological sediments.
Q.9	(B)	Unlike Brahmi (which was written left to right), the Kharosthi script was written from right to left.
Q.10	(B)	Sir Mortimer Wheeler introduced the grid system with vertical baulks to maintain stratigraphic control.
Q.11	(A)	Karl Popper proposed that scientific hypotheses must be capable of empirical testing and potential refutation.
Q.12	(B)	Ethnocentrism is the tendency to judge other cultural groups by the standards and values of one's own culture.
Q.13	(B)	Triangulation cross-checks findings using diverse data sources and methodologies to eliminate single-source bias.
Q.14	(B)	Megasthenes represented Seleucus Nicator at the Mauryan court in Pataliputra and authored the book Indica.
Q.15	(B)	Xuanzang traveled across India and studied at Nalanda during the reign of King Harsha.
Q.16	(B)	Toponymy is the linguistic and historical study of place names and geographic titles.
Q.17	(B)	The radioactive half-life of Carbon-14 is approximately 5,730 years, setting its practical dating limit at ~50,000 years.
Q.18	(B)	Modern analytical textbooks synthesized by historians are secondary sources.
Q.19	(B)	Standardized questionnaire surveys generate quantitative numerical data suitable for statistical testing.
Q.20	(B)	Palaeography is the discipline studying historical handwriting forms, script evolution, and ancient manuscripts.
Q.21	(B)	Geography is the scientific study of physical environments and their spatial interactions with human societies.
Q.22	(B)	Correlation demonstrates simultaneous association, not direct cause-and-effect proof.
Q.23	(B)	The National Curriculum Framework emphasizes critical inquiry, constitutional ethics, and democratic citizenship.
Q.24	(B)	Kalhana's 12th-century Rajatarangini ('River of Kings') is recognized as one of India's earliest critical historical chronicles.
Q.25	(B)	Scientific objectivity demands analyzing evidence impartially without distortion by personal prejudices.